

‘Flashing’ the ISO file to a USB stick

If you prefer to use a DVD-R, rather than a USB stick, then skip this section and see the one below.

There are a few ways to put an ISO image onto a USB stick these days and it’s a lot easier than it used to be. As most of us have USB sticks lying around the house, this is now the most common way to install a Linux distribution.

Download BalenaEtcher

The easiest way to put the ISO image you downloaded onto a USB stick is to use a free tool called [Etcher](https://www.balena.io/etcher). Head over to their [website](https://www.balena.io/etcher) (<https://www.balena.io/etcher>) and download the tool.

If for whatever reason you have troubles with the BalenaEtcher tool, you can alternatively use a tool called Rufus if you are using Windows. [Read this short guide](#).

Flash the ISO image to your USB stick

Once you have downloaded BalenaEtcher, open the app and insert your USB stick into your computer.

As you can see from the above image, the rest is a piece of cake. Click on ‘Select Image’ and point it to the ISO file you just downloaded. If you have already inserted your USB stick, it should already show up in the middle. Finally, just click Flash (your PC may ask you for authorisation to do this). This ‘flashing’ process takes around five minutes.